The demo you approved: 4 of 8 failed.

Three failure cases from my own code, each now a test before trust.

CASE 1 · MISSING FIELD

The provider returned nothing.

A null message body with a normal finish reason used to crash the shared client. Now empty is empty.

modules / llm_client.py

```
# Defensive extraction: some providers (notably GLM via
  OR on long
# outputs) can return message.content=None alongside a
  non-empty
# finish_reason. Treat empty as empty rather than
  AttributeError.
if not resp.choices:
    return ""
msg = resp.choices[0].message
content = getattr(msg, "content", None) or ""
```

CASE 2 · STRANGE INPUT

A blank reply. A phone number. A signature.

Each odd input became a named test before the classifier touched live replies.

tests / test_reply_classifier.py

```
def test_empty_body_returns_neutral():
    result = classify("", dry_run=True)
    assert result["class"] == "neutral"
    assert result["confidence"] == 0.0

def test_phone_number_hot_pattern():
    result = classify("Please call me at +33 6 12 34 56
  78 tomorrow.", dry_run=True)
    assert result["class"] == "hot"
```

CASE 3 · WRONG ANSWER

Fluent French. English grammar underneath.

A per-field language check flagged English connective syntax in French CV bullets across 4 of 8 evaluation cases. The model was swapped before a candidate saw it.

cv_optimizer_v2 / worker / src / anthropic.ts

```
Deep-eval on 2026-06-14 then exposed Haiku producing
  English connective syntax in bullets under FR JDs
  (langdetect flagged experience[1].bullets[1] across 4
  of 8 cases).
```

THE RULE

Each case became a test before trust.

Missing fields, strange inputs, wrong answers. None of them appeared in the demo. All of them appeared in the first week of real traffic.

Which failure would embarrass you most: a crash, a strange input handled wrongly, or a confident wrong answer?